Taumata Arowai Virtual Internship 2026
Project Brief

Company Name	**Taumata Arowai / The Water Services Authority**
Website	https://www.taumataarowai.govt.nz/
Organisation Background	Taumata Arowai is Aotearoa New Zealand's national water services regulator. Its role is to work with, regulate and influence the water services sector to improve outcomes for the health of water, people and the environment. Taumata Arowai regulates drinking water suppliers to help ensure communities receive safe drinking water, and it also has a role in supporting improvements in the environmental performance of wastewater and stormwater networks. Registered drinking water networks serve around 85% of New Zealand's population. Networks are pipes underground that distribute treated drinking water from various source types to residential and non-residential connections. Networks are divided into zones, and some networks have more than 50 zones across a city, for example. It is vital to strengthen the connection between network, zone and a residential address for both public interest, and the regulators' ability to respond to problems that may occur.
Project Name	**Connecting residents to water supplies**
Project Scope	The objective of this project is to build a live dashboard or generation tool where an address can be entered and the user know exactly which water network that address is connected to. The dashboard should use the greater Auckland region as its example product with capacity to expand to the rest of New Zealand. Students are asked to focus on creating the methodology of the dashboard in detail. Once this is established, you may then progress to building the dashboard or generation tool and allow time to test and refine the dashboard. A full handover will be completed at the end of the project.

Methods	Students are expected to apply a user-centred design approach throughout the project, ensuring the needs to the end users are central to the development of the dashboard. **Research** – gain an understanding of the Auckland area, existing water supplies and connections, and the technical structure underpinning the relation between different data points that connect sources – treatment plants- networks – zones. **All data will be provided by Taumata Arowai:** • **Data is not to be inputted into any AI tool.** • **Data is confidential and must be deleted from files/local machine at the conclusion of this project.** **Design methodology** – underpinned by strong data modelling, and taking into account user experience, privacy requirements, ease of demonstration, determine the most effective design for the dashboard. **Build** – build the dashboard using PowerBI or similar, your choice. Consider user experience, use appropriate Taumata Arowai branding for front-end. **Test and refine** – validate dashboard; implement feedback of mentor and client. **Final presentation and handover** – deliver a final presentation to Taumata Arowai demonstrating the dashboard, discussing any significant issues and how they were overcome (or not), and explaining key decisions for the build. Provide documentation and a working dashboard to Taumata Arowai which will enable them to make any future modifications and take it live.
Project Deliverables	• A final report, written as a team, summarising analysis, methodology and recommendations. The report should be up to 2,500 words including relevant citations. • A 10-minute presentation summarising your key findings and recommended methodology. • A working dashboard that enables users to correctly identify the water supply connected to any given address. The dashboard may be hosted locally or via a cloud-based platform and students should provide credentials and documentation as part of the handover. In the interests of time, UI is secondary to functionality and quality data modeling.

Evaluation	A standardised rubric will be used to evaluate the report and presentation. The team(s) will be evaluated on: • Written communication and report structure • Getting information • Analysing data and information • Critical thinking • Teamwork • Presentation skills